

CRM Sync — Migration Guide: CSV & Legacy Tools → Connected Streams

Your customer data still moves by **CSV export, UA-shaped reporting, and browser-only consent**. Each handoff is consent-blind, un-audited, and stale on arrival. This guide maps every legacy tool to a **consent-gated, logged, deduplicated connected stream** — and what to keep, replace, or augment.

For: Marketing ops, analytics teams, and CRM administrators planning the transition

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THE PROBLEM

Your team is likely still using some combination of these workflows:

- **Exporting customer CSVs from Shopify** and uploading them to your CRM, email platform, or analytics tool
- **Running Google Analytics on Universal Analytics settings** that stopped processing data in July 2024
- **Using OneTrust or a similar consent tool** that only manages cookies in the browser — with no way to verify consent on the server side
- **Importing customer lists into Klaviyo, HubSpot, or Salesforce** via spreadsheet upload
- **Tracking conversions by page URL** (/thank-you, /signup-complete) instead of actual events

Each of these workflows has a common flaw: **no consent enforcement, no audit trail, and no automatic propagation when something changes**. If a customer asks to be deleted, you have to manually find and remove their data from every spreadsheet, every CRM, every analytics platform. If consent changes, the CSV you exported yesterday is already stale.

Google, Shopify, and regulators are all moving to enforce this. The deadlines are not future — most have already passed.

WHAT'S ALREADY CHANGED

CHANGE	WHEN	IMPACT
Universal Analytics stopped processing data	July 2024	UA-shaped exports contain no new data. Any workflow built on UA goals, custom dimensions, or page-view conversions is dead.
Google requires consent_mode v2 in EEA	March 2024	Ads campaigns without the four new consent signals lose remarketing and conversion tracking
Shopify Customer Privacy API required for new apps	2025-2026	Apps that don't implement consent signaling will be rejected from the App Store
Google Merchant Center moving to server-side feeds	2025-2026	CSV product feeds are being deprecated for most categories
GDPR enforcement increasing for "consent laundering"	2026 onward	Importing contacts without verifiable consent is a regulatory target

WHAT NEEDS TO MIGRATE

Google Analytics: Page Views → Events

Google Analytics 4 fundamentally changed how conversions work. This affects every tool that reports on conversions:

OLD WAY (UNIVERSAL ANALYTICS)	NEW WAY (GA4)	WHAT BREAKS
Track conversions by URL path (/thank-you)	Track conversions by event name (purchase, sign_up)	Any tool that counts conversions by page URL stops working
Set conversion value once (static)	Value is on each event (dynamic)	CSV-imported static goal values don't exist anymore
Session-based attribution (last click)	Event-based, data-driven attribution	CRM systems importing UA session data need to import GA4 event data instead
2 consent signals (basic/advanced)	4 consent signals (ad_storage, analytics_storage, ad_user_data, ad_personalization)	Consent banners must emit all four signals or lose ad functionality

Consent: Browser Cookies → Server-Side Records

OLD WAY	NEW WAY	WHY
OneTrust sets a cookie in the browser	CRM Sync stores consent in the database (Xano)	Cookies get cleared. Server-side consent persists.
Consent state lives in the browser only	Consent state is verified on the server before any data is sent	An AI agent or automated system can check consent via API – you can't check a cookie from a server
Consent changes don't propagate	Consent change → all connected platforms notified in the same request	When a customer opts out of marketing, Klaviyo, HubSpot, and GA4 all know immediately
No audit trail of consent changes	Every consent change logged with timestamp, source, and which systems were notified	Required for GDPR Art. 15 (right of access) and Art. 30 (records of processing)

Note: CRM Sync doesn't replace your consent banner (OneTrust or similar). It replaces the server-side consent enforcement that your banner doesn't provide. Your banner tells the browser what's allowed. CRM Sync tells the server what's allowed.

Customer Data: CSV Export/Import → Connected Streams

OLD WAY	NEW WAY	WHY
Export customers.csv from Shopify	Real-time webhook + sync every 15 minutes	Max data staleness = 15 minutes, not hours/days
Upload CSV to HubSpot / Salesforce / Klaviyo	Connected stream pushes data when it changes	No manual step, no stale data, no duplicate contacts
No consent check on CSV import	Every data push checks consent before sending	"Consent laundering" (importing contacts without verified consent) is a growing regulatory target
No record of what was sent where	Every outbound push logged per platform	You can answer "which systems have this customer's data?" instantly
No deletion propagation	GDPR deletion handler removes data from all connected systems	Customer requests deletion → all platforms notified automatically

IMPACT ON SPECIFIC TOOLS

Matrixify (formerly Excelify)

- What it does:** Bulk import/export Shopify data via CSV/Excel.
- What to keep:** Product bulk operations (that's PIM Sync's domain, not CRM Sync).
- What to replace:** Customer data exports and imports. Matrixify CSVs have no consent enforcement, no audit trail, and customer PII sitting in your Downloads folder. Replace with CRM Sync's authenticated API endpoints that check consent before every data transfer.

OneTrust (and similar consent platforms)

- What to keep:** The consent banner UI that customers see and interact with.
- What to augment:** Server-side consent enforcement. OneTrust manages the user experience. CRM Sync manages the truth — storing consent in the database, checking it before every data push, and logging every change.

HubSpot / Salesforce / Klaviyo CSV Imports

What to replace: All CSV-based customer imports. Each platform gets a connected stream through CRM Sync that:

- Checks consent before sending any data
- Deduplicates contacts (no more duplicate records from email case differences)
- Logs every transfer
- Propagates deletions when a customer requests removal

Google Merchant Center CSV Feeds

What to replace: Manual CSV product feeds. Use Shopify's Google & YouTube channel (server-side sync) or CRM Sync's connected stream infrastructure for custom feeds.

UA Goal-Based Reporting (Looker, Tableau, Custom Dashboards)

What to replace: Any dashboard that queries Universal Analytics goal data. There is no migration path — UA goals are structurally incompatible with GA4. Dashboards must be rebuilt on GA4 event data.

Legacy Tool	Keep / Replace / Augment	Rationale
Matrixify	Replace (for customer data)	No consent enforcement, PII in CSVs. Keep for product bulk ops only.
OneTrust	Augment	Keep the banner. Add server-side consent enforcement via CRM Sync.
HubSpot CSV Import	Replace	Use connected stream. Consent-gated, logged, deduplicated.
Salesforce Data Loader	Replace	Use connected stream. No flat-file PII.
Klaviyo CSV List Import	Replace	Use connected stream. Email consent verified per subscriber.
Google Merchant CSV Feed	Replace	Use Shopify's Google channel or Content API.
UA Goal-Based Reporting	Replace	Rebuild on GA4 events. No migration path.
Shopify Customer CSV Export	Replace	Use authenticated API endpoint. No PII in downloads.

IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

PHASE	TIMELINE	WHAT HAPPENS
Phase 1	Week 1-2	Upgrade consent banner to GA4 consent_mode v2. Add audit logging. Rate limit auth endpoints.
Phase 2	Week 3-4	Build connected stream infrastructure. Add per-platform sync logging. UCP dashboard shows sync history.
Phase 3	Week 5-8	Connect enterprise platforms (Salesforce, Klaviyo, HubSpot, Braze, Attentive).
Phase 4	Week 9-10	Deprecate CSV imports. Archive UA references. Complete compliance certification.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Organizations still using CSV workflows for customer data are accumulating compliance debt with each passing month. The page-view conversion schema is already dead. The consent requirements are already enforced. The question is not whether to migrate, but how much process debt to carry forward.

CRM Sync replaces manual, file-based, consent-blind data handoffs with authenticated, logged, consent-aware connections — and every new platform you add inherits the same protections automatically.

Technical reference: [FEATURE-SPEC-UA-MIGRATION.md](#)